

Bazaar

We test the latest and the best hardware and software products available in the market

Intel Prescott 3.4 GHz

This is the latest from Intel Prescott line, and comes with a 200 MHz boost. Apart from the frequency increase, it also comes with revised stepping—hardware revisions—to iron out the few chinks that the 3.2 GHz Prescott had. However, this doesn't change thermal ratings, and it still dissipates more heat than the Northwood CPUs.



The 3.4 GHz also comes with 1 MB of L2 cache, 800 MHz FSB and a new heat sink. It still retains the 478-pin configuration, making it compatible with most Prescott-ready motherboards.

We plugged the CPU into an Intel 875PBZ motherboard, with Corsair 512 MB DDR 400 MHz RAM, a 120 GB Seagate Barracuda SATA hard disk and a Gigabyte 5950 graphics card, running Windows XP.

In the business benchmarks, such as Content Creation and Business Winstone from Ziff Davis, the processor posted 30.2 and 24.2 respectively. The 200 MHz increase gives

the processor a 4.8 and 1.2 per cent boost respectively, as compared to the Pentium 4 3.2 EE. This clearly indicates the advantage when running applications such as Photoshop, Maya, etc.

The gaming edge was pretty close—it outperformed the older Pentium 4, including the 3.2 GHz Prescott. However, the performance boost isn't much to write home about.

In *UT2003*, the 3.4 GHz gave a frame rate of 256 at a resolution of 640 x 480. The older 3.2 GHz ran dry at 242 frames. It was the same with *Sam Second Encounter*.

Overall, the 3.4 GHz Prescott is a good performer, but doesn't justify the price hike. Why pay Rs 10,000 more for just a little more performance, especially with the new 915 chipset, made specially for the Prescott, just round the corner.

SPECIFICATIONS

800 MHz, FSB, IMB, L2 Cache, 478 pin, 125 million transistors

Intel Prescott 3.4 GHz B

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 23,990

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BenQ FP991



The BenQ FP991 19-inch LCD monitor is worth its price tag, considering its features and performance. It offers the highest possible resolution in the 19-inch category—1280 x 1024. The display has both D-Sub and DVI-D interfaces, along with the necessary data cables.

The bezel is just 18 mm thick, so when you wall-mount it, it looks like a futuristic frame. It also has landscape and portrait modes—all you need to do is tilt the screen about 30 to 45 degrees upwards, and rotate it. The Portrait PivotPro utility bundled along adjusts the display so you can view your

documents when you rotate it.

The BenQ FP991 performed wonderfully, especially in the colour scale test, where a slide displays different shades of a colour. It managed to differentiate between all blocks—a difficult task for most LCD panels. It also passed the 16-colour intensities test, displaying all of them.

However, the test that involved coloured text on a coloured background saw it lag.

Magenta text looked terrible on most coloured backgrounds. The reddish text was not crisp enough to be read on magenta and yellow backgrounds—Web designers and graphic artists, stay away!

A couple of minuses are that the panel doesn't have an in-built power adapter. Nor does it have integrated speakers, which are, these days, considered standard accessories.

SPECIFICATIONS

0.294 mm pixel size, 25 ms pixel response time, 300 cd/m² brightness, 700:1 contrast ratio, 76 Hz vertical and 82 KHz horizontal scan rate, 8.5 Kg, 40 W power consumption

BenQ FP991 A-

Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 47,000

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